

Host guide — The Sybil's Cave Proof

Before players arrive

Privately envelope one dossier per player. Stack evidence in this order: Poe note and private history; timeline, media report, and access log; tenant abstract, voice message, and pump card. Keep this guide and the canonical truth hidden.

75-minute run of show

0–10 — Briefing. Read the public briefing and have each player state one direct observation and one inherited claim.

10–35 — Provenance. Release the Poe note, timeline, media report, and access log. At minute 25, if the proof has not been challenged, ask: 'Can an old clipping authenticate the note attached to it?'

35–60 — Rescue. Release the tenant abstract, voice message, and pump card. If anyone identifies immediate danger—or at minute 50 regardless—read the pump card aloud and narrate Quill's release. The rescue never depends on Crane's cooperation.

60–70 — Resolution. Ask for one written accusation naming the fabricator, Quill's location, and at least one corroborated evidence route. Accept a route only if it establishes fabrication, Crane's access, and the recess location.

70–75 — Debrief. Separate documented history, character testimony, physical evidence, and inference. Ask why a genuine clipping failed to authenticate the composite.

Truth

Elias Crane fabricated the site-visit note, staged it at Loom House 4C, and confined Miriam Quill in the ventilated service recess when confronted. Bell, Voss, and Vale each concealed a real but secondary act. Quill did not stage her disappearance.

Recovery ladder

First ask players to compare the May paragraph with the named November installment. Second ask them to compare physical media with chronology. Third ask who is named in both the access log and tenant abstract. Final safety recovery: hand everyone the pump card and proceed with rescue before continuing deduction.

Historical boundary

Mary Cecilia Rogers's body was recovered in the Hudson off Elysian Fields north of Sybil's Cave in 1841; the cave is not an established murder scene. Poe's **The Mystery of Marie Rogêt** analyzed the unresolved case through press reports from a distance. The game's Quill, Crane, proof packet, tenant abstract, and confinement are invented. Research sources are printed on the Poe method note.